🔑 ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS: MOCK TEST

Indian Economy on the Eve of Independence | Class 12

PREPARED BY THUNDERSTUDY ✨

SECTION A – ANSWER KEY (MCQs)

Q.No.	Ans	Explanation
1	B	Industrial growth was negligible; the economy was structural-agrarian.
2	C	Contributed approx 50% to national income (GDP).
3	B	Raw materials were extracted to feed British industries.
4	B	Dadabhai Naoroji in "Poverty and Un-British Rule in India".
5	C	Cotton and Jute were primary cash crops for export.
6	C	Lack of irrigation made agriculture a "gamble on monsoons".
7	C	Exploitative two-fold policy: Raw material supply & Finished good market.
8	A	Our world-famous handloom industry was systematically destroyed.
9	A	The only major private steel plant started in 1907.
10	B	Post-partition, India's population was around 33 crores.
11	A	Less than 16% literacy (female literacy was even lower at 7%).
12	D	Infrastructure was built ONLY for British transport/commercial needs.
13	A	Capital was redirected to British war efforts and profits.
14	B	Forced "tinkathia" system where farmers had to grow indigo.
15	A	Introduced by Lord Cornwallis in Bengal.
16	B	They were mere legal owners/collectors with fixed revenue targets.

17	B	Systematic destruction of indigenous crafts without industrial replacement.
18	C	High revenue was collected regardless of harvest success.
19	A	Specifically emphasized to tackle post-partition food shortages.
20	A	Life expectancy was extremely low (approx 32-44 years).
21	A	The Brahmaputra valley was the world's leading tea exporter.
22	A	One of the worst man-made disasters in human history.
23	B	Diversion of crops for War and total distribution failure.
24	C	British monopoly on foreign trade was strictly enforced.
25	B	Created a direct sea-route, bypassing the Cape of Good Hope.
26	B	Demographic transition stage was stagnant (High Birth/High Death).
27	B	India was reduced to a primary goods exporter.
28	A	The year population growth became consistent and rapid.
29	D	Critiques were diverse but united in anti-colonial sentiment.
30	C	Exploitation was rampant in plantation and textile mills.

SECTION B – VERY SHORT ANSWERS (POINTS)

31. Agri Features: (a) Low productivity due to old tech. (b) Forced commercialization of crops.

32. Industrial Lag: (a) Destruction of handicrafts. (b) Lack of capital goods (machines) industries.

33. Drain of Wealth: Use of India's export surplus to pay British administrative and war expenses. Popularized by Naoroji.

34. Infrastructure: (a) Indian Railways (1850). (b) Electric Telegraph for law & order.

35. Low Literacy: (a) Government's lack of social interest. (b) Extreme poverty leading to child labor.

36. Zamindari Consequences: Mass peasant evictions and total neglect of land investment.

37. Revenue Objective: To maximize collection to finance the British army and infrastructure development.

38. Handicrafts Decline: Discriminatory tariff policy (tax on exports, no tax on British imports).

39. De-industrialisation: The process where a country loses its industrial base (handicrafts) without modern industrialization appearing in its place.

40. Demographic Indicators: (a) High Infant Mortality Rate (218 per 1000). (b) Low Life Expectancy (32 years).

SECTION C & D – DESCRIPTIVE HINTS

41. Suez Canal: It served as a "direct route" for the British to exploit India faster and cheaper. It led to total British control over Indian foreign trade.

42. Zamindari System: Triangular relationship: British (Revenue) -> Zamindar (Ownership) -> Cultivator (Labor). Leading to "Agricultural Stagnation".

43. Feeder Economy: Use agriculture to produce raw materials, use industry to consume British goods, and use trade surplus to pay British "Home Charges".

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